In: Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism…
Editor: Nikolas J. Koppel
ISBN: 978-1-60741-335-6
© 2010 Nova Science Publishers, Inc.

Chapter 2

BOBBY WILKES, TESTIMONY TO THE HOUSE OVERSIGHT AND GOVERNMENT REFORM SUBCOMMITTEE ON NATIONAL SECURITY AND FOREIGN AFFAIRS

Bobby Wilkes

Chairman Tierney, Congressman Shays, Members of the Committee: Thank you for the opportunity to discuss Pakistan and Coalition Support Funds (CSF). I would like to discuss the evolution of the CSF program, the process for evaluating CSF claims, and why CSF is an important tool in the War on Terror (WOT).

Before doing so, however, it is important to understand Pakistan's place in the region and the world. Pakistan, the second most populous Muslim state and sixth most populous country in the world, is located at the geopolitical crossroads of Central Asia. With nuclear armed neighbors and with a nuclear capability itself, Pakistan lives in a very tough neighborhood. And with Afghanistan and Iran next door, it finds itself in the front lines in the battle against global terrorism. More than ever, our national security is linked to the success, security, and stability of a democratic Pakistan. We acknowledge that Pakistan has made important strides towards democracy in the past several months, but much remains to be done. The elections in February were an important step for Pakistan; we applaud the return of civilian leadership and we remain committed to helping the people of Pakistan achieve stability. Pakistan, however, is facing severe budgetary, energy, and economic crises and must act decisively to eliminate the Al Qaeda and Taliban safe havens in the Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA) and North West Frontier Province (NWFP). The new coalition government has a difficult road to navigate, and requires steadfast support.

Copyright © 2010. Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated. All rights reserved.

Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism in Pakistan's Border Region, Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated, 2010. ProQuest Ebook Central,